Stage-by-stage overview

QS-185™ is our written standard for building quality, from setting out to handover. This overview shows what our engineer checks at each of the 14 stages, and examples of the pass rules. Every checkpoint is measured against your drawings or a published code, photographed in our app, and the app applies the rule.

185
checkpoints in the standard

14
construction stages

15
visit stages, 2 repeated on every floor

80
checks rated critical

How checks add up per building

Building	Site visits	Checks
G+1, under 3,000 sqft	8	221
G+3, 3,000–6,000 sqft	12	293
G+5, 6,000–10,000 sqft	16	365

Column and slab checks repeat on every floor, so taller buildings get more checks.

After every visit

- A written report within 24 hours, with readings and photos for every checkpoint
- Every issue graded minor, major or critical
- A corrective action list naming the person responsible for each fix
- A WhatsApp alert for any failed check, and free re-inspection until it passes

Checks come from Indian Standards

Number of checkpoints that cite each code.

`IS 456 · 47` `IS 1661 · 11` `IS 732 · 10` `IS 2212 · 10` `IS 1742 · 9` `IS 3067 · 9`
`IS 1904 · 6` `IS 2395 · 6` `IS 1200 · 5` `IS 2065 · 4`

01 Drawings & Setting Out

10 checkpoints **6** critical · **3** major · **1** minor Visit V01

When we visit: Before digging starts. **Why then:** A mistake here is copied into every floor that follows, and costs the most to fix.

What we check

- Drawing sets agree, are the same revision and name the engineer
- Soil report matches the foundation design
- Approved plan, setbacks and plot boundaries
- Grid, centre lines and column positions marked on the ground
- Benchmark level fixed and recorded
- Water quality, termite treatment plan and existing services on site

Example checkpoint	Passes when	Code
QS–01–01 Architectural, structural and MEP drawings are the same revision and agree with each other	No conflict between disciplines; revision numbers match	Good practice
QS–01–03 Soil report available and bearing capacity matches the foundation design	Reported SBC ≥ design SBC	IS 1904, IS 6403
QS–01–06 Benchmark level established, marked and recorded	Permanent reference point fixed and recorded	Good practice

02 Excavation & Foundation

20 checkpoints **11** critical · **8** major · **1** minor Visit V02, V03

When we visit: With the pit open, then with the footing steel tied. **Why then:** The founding soil can only be seen while the pit is open, and footing steel is hidden once concrete is poured.

What we check

- Pit depth, base and founding soil
- Safe pit sides and anti-termite treatment
- PCC thickness, mix and level
- Footing steel: size, grade, spacing and cover
- Column starter bars and their lap length
- Shuttering
- Cement, aggregate, concrete grade, slump and cubes
- Placing and compaction of concrete

Example checkpoint	Passes when	Code
QS–02–01 Excavation depth matches the structural drawing	Within ±50 mm of drawing depth	IS 1904
QS–02–02 Founding stratum matches the soil report before PCC	Written confirmation recorded before PCC	IS 1904
QS–02–05 Anti-termite treatment applied to base and sides before PCC	Dosage and coverage per code	IS 6313

03 Plinth Beam & Backfill

12 checkpoints **4** critical · **7** major · **1** minor Visit V04

When we visit: Plinth steel and sleeves in, before the pour. **Why then:** Pipe sleeves and the damp-proof course can't be reached once the plinth is cast.

What we check

- Plinth beam size and top level
- Steel, stirrups, laps and cover
- Plumbing sleeves and conduits before the pour
- Concrete grade, slump and cubes
- Damp-proof course
- Backfill material, laid and compacted in layers
- Plinth level against the benchmark, and curing

Example checkpoint	Passes when	Code
QS–03–01 Plinth beam size and top level match the drawing	Within ±10 mm	IS 456
QS–03–05 Plumbing sleeves and conduits placed before pour	All crossings sleeved; positions per drawing	IS 1742
QS–03–03 Bar laps staggered, away from high-stress zones	No more than half the bars lapped at one section	IS 456

04 Columns Checked on every floor

16 checkpoints **12** critical · **4** major · **0** minor Visit V05

When we visit: Column steel tied, before the pour, on every floor. **Why then:** Lap length, stirrup spacing and cover are hidden for good once the column is cast.

What we check

- Column position on the grid and size
- Main bars: diameter, number and grade
- Lap length and staggered laps
- Stirrups: spacing, closer spacing at beam junctions, 135° hooks
- Cover on all four faces
- Plumb and shuttering
- Concrete grade, slump, cubes and compaction
- Stripping time and the finish after de-shuttering

Example checkpoint	Passes when	Code
QS–04–02 Column size matches the structural drawing	Within ±6 mm on each dimension	IS 456
QS–04–03 Main bar diameter, number and grade match the column schedule	Count, diameter and grade verified	IS 1786
QS–04–04 Lap length not less than the specified minimum	Per drawing, typically 40–50 × bar diameter	IS 456 Cl. 26.2.5

05 Beams & Slab

Checked on every floor

20 checkpoints **13** critical · **7** major · **0** minor Visit V06

When we visit: Slab steel laid, before the pour, on every floor. **Why then:** The most important visit in the build: everything in the slab is covered by one pour.

What we check

- Shuttering level and props
- Beam steel: top and bottom bars, extra bars, closer stirrups at supports
- Slab steel: size, spacing, bent bars and chairs for the top steel
- Cover blocks
- Conduits, sleeves and openings placed before the pour
- Slab thickness
- Concrete grade, slump and cubes; no unplanned joints
- Level finish, curing, prop removal time, cracks and sag after stripping

Example checkpoint	Passes when	Code
QS–05–02 Props adequate in number, on a firm base and braced	No prop on loose fill; bracing both ways	IS 456 Cl. 11
QS–05–03 Beam top and bottom reinforcement per drawing	Matches beam schedule at midspan and support	IS 456
QS–05–14 Concrete tested and sampled during the pour	At least 1 set of 3 cubes per 50 m³	IS 456

06 Masonry

16 checkpoints **2** critical · **12** major · **2** minor Visit V07

When we visit: Mid-way through the blockwork. **Why then:** Bonding and plumb can still be corrected while the walls are going up.

What we check

- Brick or block quality on delivery, and soaking
- Mortar mix and working time
- Wall thickness, plumb, line and level
- Joint thickness and bonding at corners and junctions
- Height laid per day
- Openings, lintels and their bearing
- Gap under beams, service chases and curing

Example checkpoint	Passes when	Code
QS–06–02 Bricks or blocks sound when struck, uniform, free of cracks	Random sample checked each delivery	IS 1077
QS–06–13 Lintels over all openings with enough bearing	Bearing per drawing, typically ≥ 150 mm each side	IS 456
QS–06–09 Mortar joints even and completely filled	10–12 mm, with no hollow joints	IS 2212

07 MEP Rough-in

16 checkpoints **7** critical · **8** major · **1** minor Visit V08

When we visit: Pipes and conduits in, before plastering. **Why then:** Pressure and flow tests must happen before pipes and wires disappear into the walls.

What we check

- Conduit quality and straight routing
- Switch, socket and distribution board positions
- Separate circuits for heavy loads; wire size
- Earth conductor throughout; no hidden joints
- Pipe material, and pressure test on water lines
- Drain slope, traps, vents, bends and sleeves
- Water test on drains, and a photo record of every route

Example checkpoint	Passes when	Code
QS–07–09 Water lines pressure-tested before concealing	No pressure drop over the test period	IS 2065
QS–07–10 Drainage line slope within the specified range	1:40 to 1:60 as specified	IS 1742
QS–07–06 Every electrical point connected to earth	Continuous at every point	IS 3043

08 Plastering

12 checkpoints **2** critical · **8** major · **2** minor Visit V09

When we visit: After plaster, before painting. **Why then:** Hollow plaster and cracks have to be found before paint hides them.

What we check

- Surface preparation: raked joints, cleaning and wetting
- Mesh where concrete meets brickwork
- Mortar mix and plaster thickness
- Plumb, line, corners and grooves
- Hollow patches and cracks
- Curing, external coats and water-repellent treatment

Example checkpoint	Passes when	Code
QS–08–01 Surface cleaned and joints raked before plaster	Raked 10–15 mm deep on masonry	IS 1661
QS–08–03 Mesh fixed where concrete meets brickwork	At least 150 mm each side	IS 1661
QS–08–09 No hollow patches in the plaster	No hollow areas	IS 1661

09 Waterproofing

10 checkpoints **7** critical · **3** major · **0** minor Visit V10

When we visit: During the ponding test. **Why then:** A leak found later means breaking finished floors and tiles.

What we check

- Surface preparation and sealed cracks
- Slope to drain points
- Waterproofing system as specified
- Upturns at parapets; pipe openings, corners and junctions
- Ponding test on terraces; test of bathroom sunken areas
- Protective screed, clear outlets and test records

Example checkpoint	Passes when	Code
QS–09–02 Screed laid with fall toward drain points	Minimum 1:100 fall to outlets	IS 3067
QS–09–06 Ponding test carried out and passed	48–72 hours, no leak, no level drop	IS 3067
QS–09–08 Bathroom sunken areas watertight before filling	Test passed and recorded before filling	IS 3067

10 Flooring & Tiling

12 checkpoints **2** critical · **6** major · **4** minor Visit V11

When we visit: During and after laying. **Why then:** Hollow tiles and wrong slopes are expensive to redo.

What we check

- Tile batch and shade
- Base level and bedding
- Hollow tiles
- Level, and slope to drains in wet areas
- Joints, grout, uneven edges and chipped tiles
- Skirting, dado height and tile layout
- Water test on wet floors; protection until handover

Example checkpoint	Passes when	Code
QS–10–02 Base level and cleanliness checked before tiling	Level within ±5 mm	IS 1443
QS–10–04 No hollow tiles	No hollow sound on tapping	IS 1443
QS–10–05 Bathroom floors slope to the drain	At least 1:50 fall, no ponding	IS 1443

11 Doors, Windows & Joinery

10 checkpoints **2** critical · **6** major · **2** minor Visit V12

When we visit: After fixing. **Why then:** Alignment and operation are checked while fixes are still easy.

What we check

- Frame and shutter material per schedule
- Frames plumb, level, fixed and grouted
- Hardware fitted and working
- Doors and windows open and close freely
- Glass thickness and type
- Water test on external windows
- Grills and railings anchored; finish

Example checkpoint	Passes when	Code
QS-11-02 Frames fixed plumb and level with enough holdfasts	3 holdfasts per jamb; plumb within 3 mm	IS 4021
QS-11-08 Windows keep the rain out	No water gets in	Good practice
QS-11-09 Railings and grills anchored into the structure	Anchored into the structure	IS 1200

12 Painting & Finishes

9 checkpoints **1** critical · **5** major · **3** minor Visit V13

When we visit: After the final coat. **Why then:** Damp walls and missed coats show up later as peeling and patches.

What we check

- Surface dry before painting
- Putty, primer and number of coats
- Paint used against the area painted
- Finish in daylight and clean edges
- External paint system
- Protection of finished surfaces

Example checkpoint	Passes when	Code
QS-12-01 Surface dry and free of damp before painting	No damp patches; moisture in range	IS 2395
QS-12-04 The specified number of coats applied	At least 2 finish coats; shade as approved	IS 2395
QS-12-05 Paint used matches the area painted	In line with the stated coverage	Good practice

13 MEP Final Fit-out

12 checkpoints **8** critical · **4** major · **0** minor Visit V14

When we visit: After fixtures are installed. **Why then:** Earthing and insulation tests are a safety requirement before anyone moves in.

What we check

- Switches and fittings ISI marked; every point working
- Distribution board labelled; breaker ratings
- Earth resistance, insulation resistance and RCCB trip
- Sanitaryware level and leak-free
- Water pressure and drain flow at every fixture
- Tanks, sump and pump controls
- Rainwater harvesting

Example checkpoint	Passes when	Code
QS-13-04 Earth resistance measured and within the limit	Measured value within the code limit	IS 3043
QS-13-05 Insulation resistance tested and recorded	Per IS 732 acceptance value	IS 732
QS-13-06 The safety trip (RCCB) cuts the power when it should	Trips within its rated time and current	IS 732

14 External Works & Handover

10 checkpoints **3** critical · **5** major · **2** minor Visit V15

When we visit: At completion. **Why then:** Test records are compiled and every snag is closed before handover.

What we check

- Compound wall and gate
- Septic tank and sump watertight
- Paving slope and drainage around the building
- Site cleared
- Snag list closed
- Test records, as-built drawings, warranties and manuals handed over

Example checkpoint	Passes when	Code
QS-14-03 Septic tank and sump sized right and watertight	No measurable loss over 24 hours	IS 2470
QS-14-08 All test records compiled and handed over	Cube, pressure, ponding and earthing records complete	IS 456 Cl. 16
QS-14-07 Every snag fixed and signed off	Every item signed off	Good practice

Price per visit

Up to 3,000 sqft	₹2,000
3,000 – 6,000 sqft	₹2,800
6,000 – 10,000 sqft	₹4,000

Book a QA visit on the Our Standard page of our website.